Wayne Kim

Interaction Designer & Researcher

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I'm an Interaction Designer and Researcher who builds physical prototypes and tests them with real people. After 10 years in design research and strategy at Designit and early and growth-stage startups, I completed a Master's in Interaction Design at CIID, sharpening my ability to move between research, rapid prototyping, and hands-on fabrication.

SELECTED PROJECTS, 2025

Toilet Paper Elevator

Ambient Technology, Physical Computing

Household resource use made visible: toilet paper becomes an elevator ride past real landmarks on a quiet e-ink screen. I built the Hall effect sensor tracking and CAD-modeled housing in 7 days.

Living.fm

AI Interaction, Computer Vision

Liv, a portable AI home narrator built with a Teachable Machine vision model and ElevenLabs voice, responding to everyday behavior like scrolling or stretching with contextual commentary. Built with Cursor from concept to working prototype.

room_tone

Ambient Technology, Physical Computing

A system that notices when you've sat too long and offers a slow return of light, motion, and sound, no guilt, no reminder. I built the Python state machine with Cursor, driving a motorized disco ball, smart plugs, and Spotify API.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Glorify | Senior UX Researcher

Los Angeles, CA, Feb 2023 – Feb 2024

Grew Glorify's research team from one to three. Led study with real small groups showing an early community feature strengthened connection rather than replacing it, convincing leadership to build it, now 1.8M+ users, 1 in 5 daily.

Designit | Design Researcher

Remote / NYC, Aug 2021 – Jan 2023

Global design consultancy. Led end-to-end mixed methods research for Fortune 500 clients and co-facilitated a 3-day, 60-participant design thinking workshop that translated C-suite priorities into product strategy. Also developed Foresight POVs.

RaiseMe | UX Strategist

San Francisco, CA, Dec 2017 – Jun 2020

Researched and redesigned how 330+ college partners received their enrollment data, replacing a manual, error-prone export process with automatic, ready-to-use reports. Cut a weekly task from 15 minutes to 2 and helped retain 90%+ of revenue at risk.

EDUCATION

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design (CIID)

Master's in Interaction Design | Sept 2024 – Aug 2025

Spent a year in physical prototyping, working across 3D printing, laser cutting, fabrication, and embedded computing alongside research and interaction design coursework.

Colby College

B.A. in Sociology | Sept 2010 – May 2014

SKILLS

Design: Interaction design, physical computing, sensor-based tracking, rapid prototyping, fabrication, 3D design, Wizard-of-Oz testing, video prototyping, mixed-methods research (diary studies, interviews, usability testing), workshop facilitation, storytelling

Tools: Arduino, Fusion 360, Python, Processing, 3D printing, laser cutting, Cursor, Claude Code, TouchDesigner, Unity, Kinect, Figma, Resolume, DaVinci Resolve